

Handout 4.4: Home Energy Audit Checklist and Sample Bill

Name: _____ Date: _____ Team: _____ Zone: _____

Directions: Day 1: fill in Part 1 during the slides. Then do Part 2 with a partner and a calculator. Day 2: use the checklist in Part 3 on your zone of the classroom. Use it again on the apartment in Part 4. Rank the fixes. Then read the bill in Part 5.

Word bank in Spanish

English	Spanish
energy	energía
water	agua
save (conserve)	ahorrar (conservar)
cost	costo
bill	factura (recibo)
light bulb	bombilla (foco)
thermostat	termostato
leak	fuga (gotera)

Part 1: Where it goes

Energy in a typical home (fill in the share as I show it)

Use	About what share
Heating and cooling	
Heating water	
Everything else (lights, fridge, laundry, electronics, cooking)	

Water in a typical home

Use	About what share
Toilets	
Showers	
Faucets	
Laundry	
Leaks	

Phantom load means: _____

Conservation means: _____

Efficiency means: _____

Part 2: The math

Use the template every time. Watt-hours are pennies. Kilowatt-hours are dollars.

The template

Step	Write it
watts x hours a day x days a year = watt-hours (Wh)	___ x ___ x ___ = ___ Wh
divide by 1,000 = kilowatt-hours (kWh)	___ Wh / 1,000 = ___ kWh
kWh x price per kWh = dollars	___ x \$0.25 = \$___

Worked with me: a 60 W bulb, 5 hours a day, 365 days, at \$0.25 per kWh.

60 x 5 x 365 = ___ Wh. Divide by 1,000 = ___ kWh. Times \$0.25 = \$___ a year.

The LED: 9 W. 9 x 5 x 365 = ___ Wh = ___ kWh = \$___ a year. Savings for one bulb: \$___

Practice 1. A TV is left on 6 hours a day. It uses 100 W. Price \$0.25 per kWh. Cost for a year?

___ x ___ x 365 = ___ Wh = ___ kWh = \$___

Practice 2. A game console in standby draws 15 W all day, 24 hours, 365 days. Cost for a year at \$0.25?

___ x ___ x 365 = ___ Wh = ___ kWh = \$___

Practice 3. A faucet drips once a second. That is about 5 gallons a day. Gallons in a year? A bathtub holds about 60 gallons. How many bathtubs?

5 x 365 = ___ gallons. ___ / 60 = about ___ bathtubs.

Thermostat. Each degree you set back for 8 hours saves about 1 percent of the heating bill. A family heats for \$1,800 a year and sets back 7 degrees at night. Savings: 7 percent of \$1,800 = \$___

Part 3: The audit checklist

Score every line: OK, Fix (free), or Fix (\$). Use this on your classroom zone (Day 2, Step 1).

Line	What to look for	OK	Fix (free)	Fix (\$)	What exactly
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Lights 1	Lights on where nobody is				
Lights 2	Bulbs are LED (check the label or the shape)				
Phantom 1	Chargers plugged in with nothing attached				
Phantom 2	Screens, consoles, printers on standby				
Heat 1	Thermostat setting (write it if you can read it)				
Heat 2	Windows or doors open while heat or AC runs				
Heat 3	Vents or radiators blocked by furniture				
Heat 4	Drafts at doors and windows (hold a hand near the edge)				
Water 1	Any faucet dripping				
Water 2	Toilet running (listen)				
Appliance 1	Fridge door seal holds a sheet of				

	paper				
Appliance 2	Dishwasher or laundry run only when full				

The planted waste in our zone was: _____

Part 4: Audit the apartment

The Marchetti-Oyelaran apartment. Two adults and one child, age 8, in a rented two-bedroom apartment. The landlord pays for heat. The family pays for electricity and hot water.

Living room. The TV is on all day for the dog. A cable box and a game console are on standby under it. Three lamps have the old round bulbs that get hot. A window air conditioner is still in the window in January with a towel stuffed around it. The couch sits in front of the radiator.

Kitchen. The refrigerator door has a torn seal at the bottom; a sheet of paper slides out. The dishwasher is run every night, half full. The faucet drips about once a second. The microwave clock is on. The range hood light is on all day.

Bathroom. The shower runs about 15 minutes per person, three people a day. The showerhead is the original from when the building was built. The toilet runs for a minute after each flush, then stops.

Bedrooms. Two phone chargers and a laptop charger stay plugged in with nothing attached. A space heater runs in the child's room all night with the window cracked open "for fresh air." A lamp with an old bulb is on in the empty adult bedroom while everyone is in the living room.

Score the apartment on the same twelve lines:

Line	OK	Fix (free)	Fix (\$)	What exactly
Lights 1				
Lights 2				
Phantom 1				
Phantom 2				
Heat 1				
Heat 2				
Heat 3				

Heat 4				
Water 1				
Water 2				
Appliance 1				
Appliance 2				

Rank the fixes

Here are twelve fixes. Each one has a cost and a guess at how much it saves per year. Cross out the two that cost more than \$50. Rank the other ten by savings, highest first. Five of those ten cost money. For each of those five, find the payback: cost divided by savings = years.

Fix	Cost	Saves per year (estimate)	Rank	Payback (years)
Turn off lights in empty rooms	\$0	\$20		
Unplug the chargers and put the TV, cable box, and console on a power strip you switch off	\$20 (strip)	\$50		
Swap the ten old bulbs for LEDs	\$30	\$230		
Set the thermostat back 7 degrees at night (in a home that pays for heat)	\$0	\$125		
Cut showers from 15 minutes to 8 (three people)	\$0	\$150		
Fix the dripping faucet (a new washer)	\$2	\$15		

Low-flow showerhead	\$15	\$70		
Wash laundry in cold water	\$0	\$60		
Weatherstrip the drafty window and door	\$25	\$80		
Run the dishwasher only when full	\$0	\$30		
Programmable thermostat	\$80	\$150		
New refrigerator with a good seal	\$900	\$90		

Why the top three are the top three:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

(a) Which fixes should the landlord pay for? _____

(b) Which fixes should the family pay for? Why? _____

Part 5: Read a sample electric bill

Sample electric bill, one month (made up for class)

Line	Amount
Electricity used this month	650 kWh
Supply charge: 650 kWh x \$0.12	\$78.00
Delivery charge: 650 kWh x \$0.13	\$84.50
Basic service charge (fixed, every month)	\$18.00
Total due	\$180.50

1. Circle the kWh used. Circle the total.
2. Supply plus delivery is the price per kWh: $\$0.12 + \$0.13 = \$____$ per kWh.
3. Which charge stays the same even if you use zero electricity? _____
4. If this family swaps ten old bulbs for LEDs and saves about \$230 a year, about how much lower is next month's bill? $\$230 / 12 = \text{about } \$____$